

ASSEMBLING THE ISS

Zarya, 1998

The first module, Zarya was launched on a Russian rocket in 1998. It was soon joined by the American module, Unity.



Zvezda, 2000

Launched in 2000, the Russian module Zvezda was the third. It provided life support for the first crew on the ISS.



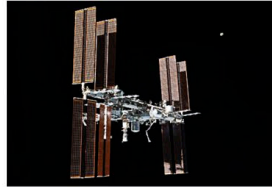
Laboratories, 2005

In 2005, the space shuttle Discovery had a grandstand view of the half-finished ISS when it delivered scientific equipment to the station.



Completed, 2011

The final space shuttle flight in 2011 saw Atlantis travel to the ISS. The space station was now complete.



Mating adapters allow spacecraft and modules to dock

Russian module Zarya

Soyuz spacecraft, used to take astronauts to and from the ISS

The Italian-built Leonardo module is a storage area

Russian module Zvezda